CLOSED LOST | MID-MARKET · DIRECT | STREAMING TV

Globex Media Deal Review

Globex Media — Streaming TV, $85K · Lost "Budget cut" · AE: Morgan Lee · Mgr: Dana Chen

Lost 2026-06-30
Prepared by Sales Ops

OUTCOME	AMOUNT	CYCLE	CLOSE-DATE SLIPS	ENGAGEMENT
Closed Lost	**$85K**	**~5 mo**	**5×**	**2 calls**
Jun 30, 2026 · "Budget cut"	cut from $140K · never booked	Feb → Jun 2026	~3 mo stalled in Proposal	Inbound demo request

Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	Phase 5
Inbound & Demo	**Discovery**	**Proposal (Stalled)**	**Decision**	**Closed Lost**
Feb 2026	Feb – Mar	Mar – Jun	Jun	Jun 30

WHY THIS DEAL WAS LOST

Recorded loss reason: **"Budget cut."** An inbound demo request created early momentum, but the champion never secured executive budget sign-off. Facing a mid-year spend freeze, the deal slowly stalled — five close-date pushes over three months in Proposal — while the scope was quietly halved ($140K → $85K) without a reset. It ended as a no-decision, not a competitive loss, which makes it re-engageable next budget cycle.

DEAL CONTEXT

Mid-Market / Direct, new business. Product: Streaming TV. Champion Alex Doyle (Marketing Manager) was enthusiastic but not the economic buyer; the VP of Finance controlled the budget and never joined a call. When a company-wide spend freeze hit in Q2, the un-sponsored deal had no internal advocate senior enough to protect it.

DEAL TIMELINE

Feb 6, 2026

Inbound demo request

Alex Doyle (Marketing Manager) requests a demo via the website.

Inbound intent

Feb 11, 2026

Demo call

Strong interest in CTV for a brand-awareness push; champion engaged.

Feb 13, 2026

SF: Opportunity created — $140K

Stage Discovery; ambitious initial scope.

Mar 4, 2026

SF: Stage → Proposal

Proposal sent; probability set to 60%.

Mar 20 – May 28, 2026

SF: Close date slips five times

Mar 31 → Apr 15 → Apr 30 → May 20 → Jun 15 — stuck in Proposal awaiting budget sign-off.

Serial slippage · no exec sponsor

Apr 22, 2026

Check-in call — budget uncertainty

Champion flags a possible spend freeze; asks for a smaller option. Economic buyer still absent.

Risk surfaced, not escalated

May 2, 2026

SF: Amount cut $140K → $85K

Scope halved to fit a reduced budget; plan not re-baselined.

Scope cut without reset

Jun 30, 2026

SF: Closed Lost — "Budget cut"

Probability 60 → 0 the same day; no re-engage task or future date logged.

Closed Lost

CALL DEEP DIVES

Call 1: Demo

Demo

Feb 11, 2026 · 30 min · Morgan Lee (AE), Alex Doyle (Marketing Manager)

Inbound demo for a brand-awareness push. Champion enthusiastic about CTV reach and measurement, but budget ownership and timeline were left vague.

SIGNALS

- ✓ Inbound, high initial enthusiasm
- ✓ Clear use case (brand awareness)

RISK SIGNALS

- ⚠ Champion is not the economic buyer
- ⚠ No budget owner identified or invited

Call 2: Check-in

Mid-deal

Apr 22, 2026 · 22 min · Morgan Lee (AE), Alex Doyle (Marketing Manager)

Champion signals a possible company-wide spend freeze and asks for a smaller package. The economic buyer (VP Finance) still had not joined any conversation.

BLOCKERS

- ⚠ Spend freeze looming; budget not secured
- ⚠ No path to the VP of Finance

WHAT WAS MISSING

- ⚠ Deal already ~7 weeks stalled in Proposal
- • No exec escalation or multi-thread attempt

KEY MOMENTS

THE CORE BLOCKER

- No executive budget sponsor
- Champion enthusiastic but not empowered

DEAL ECONOMICS

- Scope halved $140K → $85K
- Never re-baselined after the cut

- Q2 spend freeze killed an un-protected deal

- No-decision, not a competitive loss

FORECAST BEHAVIOR

- 5 close-date slips; ~3 mo in Proposal
- Held at 60% until the day it was lost
- Dropped 60% → 0% at Closed Lost

RELATIONSHIP HEALTH

- Warm inbound origin
- Single-threaded on the champion
- Door remains open next cycle

RE-ENGAGEMENT PATH

1 · RE-TIME TO BUDGET CYCLE

The loss was budget timing, not a no. Set a re-engage task now for the next planning window and re-open with a right-sized pilot.

2 · MULTI-THREAD TO FINANCE

Get to the VP of Finance early next time — the deal died un-sponsored. Arm the champion with a one-page business case for exec sign-off.

3 · LEAD WITH A PILOT

Re-approach with a low-commitment pilot and a brand-lift study so value is proven before a full-budget ask.

PROCESS GAPS

GAP 1: NO RE-ENGAGE TASK AT CLOSE

A 'Budget cut' loss is highly re-engageable, yet the opp closed with no re-engage task, future date, or next step logged.

Recommendation: Make a dated re-engage task mandatory in the Closed Lost flow when the reason is budget/timing.

GAP 2: NO EXECUTIVE SPONSOR

The deal ran for five months single-threaded on a champion who never had budget authority; the economic buyer never joined a call.

Recommendation: Require an identified economic buyer to advance past Discovery; block Proposal without a mapped budget owner.

GAP 3: SERIAL CLOSE-DATE SLIPPAGE

The close date moved five times over three months, each push keeping the deal 'alive' without a changed commitment.

GAP 4: HAPPY-EARS FORECAST

Probability sat at 60% in Proposal for ~3 months, then dropped to 0% the day it was lost — the forecast never reflected the deal's health.

Recommendation: Require a reason on every close-date change; auto-flag any opp with 3+ pushes for a qualify-or-kill review.

Recommendation: Tie probability to objective stage-exit criteria; down-rank stale high-probability opps in the weekly review.

GAP 5: SCOPE CUT WITHOUT RE-BASELINE

The amount was halved ($140K → $85K) mid-deal with no reset of plan, timeline, or decision criteria.

Recommendation: Treat a >25% amount change as a re-baseline trigger — reconfirm scope, timeline, and close plan.

GAP 6: RISK NOT ESCALATED

The champion flagged a spend freeze on the April call, but no manager escalation or save-play was logged before the deal died.

Recommendation: Log deal risks as tracked items; trigger a manager review when a budget-freeze risk is raised on an active deal.